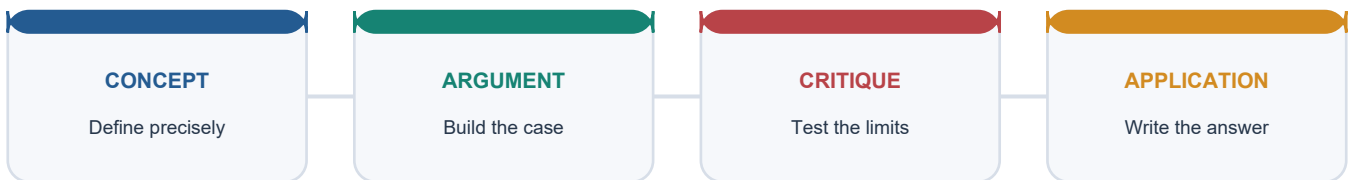


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Political Theory **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Cross-application:** GS-I, GS-IV and Essay only where genuinely relevant **Classification firewall:** Political Theory is a GS/Prelims foundation, not a separate UPSC paper. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; Advanced enrichment only after practice.

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

- **Core scope:** traditional, behavioural, post-behavioural and model-based approaches.
- **Source rule:** canonical Basic/Core, Advanced, assembled package, official GS mapping, routed Prelims/GS ledgers and OCR-searchable local books were reconciled before repair.
- **PYQ rule:** only directly verified Prelims/GS Mains questions may be owned; when none exists, original GS practice is labelled honestly.
- **Writing rule:** claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification/link to demand.
- **Advanced rule:** OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH means enrichment beyond a core GS answer and never a separate-paper classification.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Method, Approach and the Methodological Turn

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **Exam relevance:** GS-II (Polity & Governance) conceptual foundation; GS-II conceptual foundation. **Core area:** How political inquiry is framed-method, approach, facts, values, and the rise of behavioural and post-behavioural analysis. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.4, PDF pp.108-134. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md.

1. One-screen conceptual map

- **FACT:** Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- **FACT:** Traditional and contemporary are historical labels; they do not exactly coincide with normative and empirical. (PDF pp.109-110)
- **FACT:** Empirical inquiry studies what can be observed and tested; normative inquiry judges what ought to be preferred or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)
- **FACT:** Behaviouralism pushed political science toward scientific study of actual political behaviour, regularities, verification and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)
- **FACT:** Post-behaviouralism kept scientific gains but demanded relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- **ANALYSIS:** UPSC key: this topic tells you not only what politics is, but how different scholars choose to study it.

2. Why this topic matters

- **FACT:** Gauba shows that disputes in political theory are often methodological before they become ideological. (PDF pp.108-122)
- **FACT:** It helps distinguish description from prescription without collapsing one into the other. (PDF pp.110-112)
- **FACT:** It introduces the major traditional approaches-philosophical, historical, legal and institutional-and the later behavioural turn. (PDF pp.112-122)

- ANALYSIS: This topic directly extends the theory/science distinction mapped for the module in Political-Theory/README.md and Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md.
- ANALYSIS: In Optional answers, clean method language often separates average answers from high-scoring answers.

2A. Origin and timeline of approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism

FACT: The dated spine below is taken directly from the routed pages (gauba PDF pp.108-134) rather than from earlier notes. ANALYSIS: Chronology matters here because a Political Theory answer that names a position without the work or the period behind it reads as assertion; naming the anchor converts the same sentence into evidence.

Dated rail drawn from the routed source pages (each row reproduces a name, life-date, work or event exactly as the local source records it):

Anchor	Name, work or event	What the source attaches to it
1859	FACT: Preface to A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy	Marx expressed this idea in his Preface to A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy (1859) as follows:
1921	FACT: Study of Politics' published in American Political Science Review	In the article 'The Present State of the Study of Politics' published in American Political Science Review (1921) and in his book New Aspects of Politics (1925) Merriam criticized contemporary political science for its lack of scientific rigour
1925	FACT: New Aspects of Politics	In the article 'The Present State of the Study of Politics' published in American Political Science Review (1921) and in his book New Aspects of Politics (1925) Merriam criticized contemporary political science for its lack of scientific rigour
1925	FACT: American Political Science Association	In his presidential address to the American Political Science Association (1925) Merriam exhorted political scientists to look at political behaviour as one of the essential objects of inquiry
1927	FACT: Catlin, in his Science and Method of Politics	Catlin, in his Science and Method of Politics (1927) advanced the case for a 'value-free' pure science
1936	FACT: Who Gets What, When, How	Who Gets What, When, How (1936) proved to be a landmark in the empirical approach to politics as the study and analysis of power
1953	FACT: Weldon, in his Vocabulary of Politics	Weldon, in his Vocabulary of Politics (1953) pointed out that a political philosophy is like a matter of taste; one can only state one's taste and go away - there is no point in arguing
1962	FACT: Thomas Kuhn's The Structure of Scientific Revolutions	Within the sphere of philosophy of science the publication of Thomas Kuhn's The Structure of Scientific Revolutions (1962) had promoted the view that significance of scientific method lies in its capacity of problem-solving and crisis-management, not in methodological sophistication
1966	FACT: A Developmental Approach	A Developmental Approach (1966)

ANALYSIS: Dating discipline: use only the anchors in this rail. Do not attach a year to a name the source leaves undated, and do not convert a 2009-edition chronology into a claim about later scholarship.

Visual-first recall

METHOD, APPROACH AND THE METHODOLOGICAL TURN

- |
- [1] Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for...
- v
- [2] Traditional and contemporary are historical labels; they do not exactly coincide with...
- v
- [3] Empirical inquiry studies what can be observed and tested; normative inquiry judges...
- v
- [4] Behaviouralism pushed political science toward scientific study of actual political...

Answer-grabbing line: Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

Must-write keywords: Subject;; Tier;; Exam relevance;; Core area;; Grounded in;; Source edition/cutoff;; Method.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109) **Named evidence/example:** Traditional and contemporary are historical labels; they do not exactly coincide with normative and empirical. (PDF pp.109-110) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how method, approach and the methodological turn shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

SESSION 2 - Empirical and Normative Inquiry by Content

3. Essential definitions

Term	Exam-ready meaning
Method	FACT: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. (PDF p.108)
Approach	FACT: A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. (PDF pp.108-109)
Empirical statement	FACT: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation. (PDF pp.110-111)
Normative statement	FACT: A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)
Behaviouralism	FACT: A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. (PDF pp.118-121)
Post-behaviouralism	FACT: A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. (PDF pp.121-122)

4. Core argument / chapter spine

- FACT: Gauba begins by separating method from approach so that students do not confuse tools of inquiry with frames of inquiry. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: He then warns that traditional/contemporary and normative/empirical are not identical pairs. (PDF pp.109-110)
- FACT: He clarifies that empirical vs normative turns on the content of the claim, not just the grammatical presence of "is" or "ought". (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: The contemporary shift is marked by behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and several models of political analysis. (PDF pp.117-134)

- ANALYSIS: The chapter's deeper message is integrative: political science is weakened both by value-blind technique and by unsupported moral assertion.

Visual-first recall

EMPIRICAL AND NORMATIVE INQUIRY BY CONTENT

- |
- [1] Term - Exam-ready meaning
- ↓
- [2] Method - The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are...
- ↓
- [3] Approach - A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems,...
- ↓
- [4] Empirical statement - A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or...

Answer-grabbing line: Term - Exam-ready meaning

Must-write keywords: Empirical; Normative Inquiry; Content; SESSION; Essential; Term; Exam-ready.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Term - Exam-ready meaning **Named evidence/example:** Method - The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. (PDF p.108) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how empirical and normative inquiry by content shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Approach - A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. (PDF pp.108-109)

SESSION 3 - Traditional Approaches and Their Thinkers

5. Essential distinctions

- FACT: Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: Traditional vs contemporary: the first cluster is associated with philosophy, history, law and institutions, while the second focuses more on process, behaviour and analysis models. (PDF pp.109-110, 117-118)
- FACT: Empirical vs normative: empirical asks what is observable and testable; normative asks what is right, just or preferable. (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: Form vs content: a sentence using "ought" may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition, while a sentence using "is" may still be normative if it defines a value like justice. (PDF pp.110-111)
- FACT: Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)

6. Thinkers and positions

Thinker / stream	Position in this chapter
Vernon Van Dyke	FACT: Clarifies the distinction between approach and method and explains philosophical analysis as conceptual clarification plus evaluation. (PDF pp.108-109, 113)
Leo Strauss	FACT: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. (PDF pp.112, 114, 121)
Graham Wallas and Arthur Bentley	FACT: Early forerunners of behaviouralism who shift attention toward actual behaviour and informal processes. (PDF p.118)
Charles Merriam	FACT: Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinarity and behavioural inquiry. (PDF pp.118-119)
Harold Lasswell	FACT: Develops politics as the analysis of power and policy. (PDF p.119)
David Easton	FACT: Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. (PDF pp.120-122)

Visual-first recall

TRADITIONAL APPROACHES AND THEIR THINKERS

- |
- [1] Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions...
- v
- [2] Traditional vs contemporary: the first cluster is associated with philosophy,...
- v
- [3] Empirical vs normative: empirical asks what is observable and testable; normative...
- v
- [4] Form vs content: a sentence using "ought" may still be empirical if it states an...

Answer-grabbing line: Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)

Must-write keywords: Traditional Approaches; Their Thinkers; SESSION; Essential; Method; Traditional; Empirical.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109) **Named evidence/example:** Traditional vs contemporary: the first cluster is associated with philosophy, history, law and institutions, while the second focuses more on process, behaviour and analysis models. (PDF pp.109-110, 117-118) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how traditional approaches and their thinkers shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)

SESSION 4 - Illustrations, Comparison and Trap Repair

7. Illustrative examples

- FACT: "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)
- FACT: "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it appears in the form of an "is" statement. (PDF p.110)
- FACT: Legal analysis of Indian politics would ask what constitutional provisions authorize institutions and actions. (PDF pp.115-116)
- FACT: Institutional analysis would map legislature, executive, judiciary, parties and their formal relations. (PDF pp.116-117)

- ANALYSIS: Behavioural analysis of the same political scene would ask how voters, leaders, parties and interest groups actually behave.

8. Comparison table

Approach cluster	Core claim	Main focus	Limitation flagged by Gauba
Traditional	FACT: Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. (PDF pp.109-117)	FACT: Concepts, thought, legal framework, institutions. (PDF pp.113-117)	FACT: Often descriptive or normative without enough behavioural/process analysis. (PDF pp.117-118)
Behavioural	FACT: Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)	FACT: Individuals, attitudes, participation, communication, decision-processes. (PDF pp.119-121)	FACT: Risk of excessive micro-focus, method-fetish and value-neutral distance from urgent public issues. (PDF pp.121-122)
Post-behavioural	FACT: Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. (PDF pp.121-122)	FACT: Social problems, public responsibility, applied knowledge. (PDF pp.121-122)	ANALYSIS: It must not become a licence for untested moralism; relevance still needs disciplined inquiry.

Visual-first recall

ILLUSTRATIONS, COMPARISON AND TRAP REPAIR

- |
- [1] "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its...
- v
- [2] "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it...
- v
- [3] Legal analysis of Indian politics would ask what constitutional provisions authorize...
- v
- [4] Institutional analysis would map legislature, executive, judiciary, parties and their...

Answer-grabbing line: "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)

Must-write keywords: Illustrations; Comparison; Trap Repair; SESSION; Illustrative; Everybody; Justice.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111) **Named evidence/example:** "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it appears in the form of an "is" statement. (PDF p.110) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how illustrations, comparison and trap repair shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Behavioural analysis of the same political scene would ask how voters, leaders, parties and interest groups actually behave.

SESSION 5 - Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

9. UPSC traps and corrections

- WRONG: Method and approach are synonyms. -> FACT: Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- WRONG: Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical. -> FACT: Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)
- WRONG: Any sentence with "ought" is normative. -> FACT: Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- WRONG: Value-free means politically consequence-free. -> FACT: Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)
- WRONG: Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism. -> FACT: Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)

10. Cross-links and boundaries

- FACT: Sections 13-19 of this file already reconstruct the eight behavioural tenets and all five analytical models (Easton, Almond, Deutsch, decision-making, Marxian) with claim->evidence->significance->limit; use Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md only for further comparative depth and extra answer-engine prompts, not as a requirement for full marks.
- ANALYSIS: Read Political-Theory/basic/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md first if the nature of politics itself is unclear.
- ANALYSIS: Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the module-wide theory/science decode engine.
- ANALYSIS: Use Political-Theory/README.md for the topic map and tag policy.
- ANALYSIS: Boundary: this file explains ways of studying politics; it does not duplicate detailed constitutional or public-administration content.

11. Revision capsule / answer spine

- FACT: Method = procedure; approach = procedure plus problem/data selection. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: Empirical vs normative depends on content, not grammar alone. (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: Traditional approaches: philosophical, historical, legal, institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)
- FACT: Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)
- ANALYSIS: Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment.

12. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.4, especially PDF pp.108-122 for basic distinctions and the behavioural/post-behavioural debate.
 - FACT: Traditional-approach anchor pages: PDF pp.113-117.
 - FACT: Behavioural anchor pages: PDF pp.118-121.
 - FACT: Post-behavioural anchor pages: PDF pp.121-122.
 - FACT: This basic file reconstructs behaviouralism's eight tenets and all five analytical models (systems, structural-functional, communications/cybernetic, decision-making, Marxian) directly, so it is independently sufficient for full-mark answers; the advanced companion adds further comparative depth and answer-engine prompts.
-

Visual-first recall

BOUNDARIES, REVISION AND SOURCE DISCIPLINE

- |
- [1] Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-...
- ▼
- [2] Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical. -> Gauba...
- ▼
- [3] Any sentence with "ought" is normative. -> Its content may still be empirical if it...
- ▼
- [4] Value-free means politically consequence-free. -> Behavioural inquiry can shape what...

Answer-grabbing line: Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

Must-write keywords: Boundaries; Revision; Source Discipline; SESSION; UPSC; Method; Approach.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109) **Named evidence/example:** Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical. -> Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how boundaries, revision and source discipline shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

SESSION 6 - Behaviouralism's Eight Tenets

13. Behaviouralism's eight commonly taught tenets (provenance caution)

- ANALYSIS: These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to **David Easton's** account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's own 1969 listing). Treat the list below as a widely used pedagogical summary rather than a verbatim quotation of any single sentence:
 1. **Regularities** - political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
 2. **Verification** - those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
 3. **Techniques** - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
 4. **Quantification** - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
 5. **Values** - an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
 6. **Systematization** - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
 7. **Pure science** - understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.
 8. **Integration** - political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- ANALYSIS: Exam use: naming these eight in order and pairing two or three with a one-line illustration (e.g. quantification -> voting-behaviour surveys; integration -> borrowing psychology for leadership studies) earns more marks than a vague "behaviouralism is scientific" line.

Visual-first recall

BEHAVIOURALISM'S EIGHT TENETS

- |
- [1] These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via...
- v
- [2] 1. Regularities - political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as...
- v
- [3] 2. Verification - those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable...
- v
- [4] 3. Techniques - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used...

Answer-grabbing line: These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to David Easton's account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's own 1969 listing). Treat.

Must-write keywords: David Easton; Regularities; Verification; Techniques; Quantification; Values; Systematization.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to David Easton's account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's own 1969 listing). Treat the list below as a widely used pedagogical summary rather than a verbatim quotation of any single sentence: **Named evidence/example:** 1. Regularities - political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how behaviouralism's eight tenets shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** 4. Quantification - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.

SESSION 7 - Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action

14. Post-behaviouralism: relevance and action

- FACT: Post-behaviouralism, associated with Easton's own self-correction, retains the scientific gains of behaviouralism (rigour, verification, technique) but adds two demands: **relevance** - political science must address urgent public problems (war, poverty, discrimination, injustice) rather than only tractable micro-questions - and **action** - intellectuals bear responsibility to apply knowledge for social betterment, not merely to accumulate value-neutral findings. (PDF pp.121-122)
- ANALYSIS: Post-behaviouralism is a corrective *within* science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism political science was trying to escape.

Visual-first recall

POST-BEHAVIOURAL RELEVANCE AND ACTION

- |
- [1] Post-behaviouralism is a corrective **within** science, not a licence for unexamined...
- v
- [2] Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action must be linked to Approaches, Behaviouralism...
- v
- [3] Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action must be linked to Approaches, Behaviouralism...

Answer-grabbing line: Post-behaviouralism is a corrective *within* science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism.

Must-write keywords: relevance; action; Post-Behavioural Relevance; Action; SESSION; Post-behaviouralism; Easton.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Post-behaviouralism is a corrective *within* science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism political science was trying to escape. **Named evidence/example:** Post-Behavioural Relevance and Action must be linked to Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism's central conceptual dispute. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how post-behavioural relevance and action shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Post-behaviouralism is a corrective *within* science, not a licence

for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism political science was trying to escape.

SESSION 8 - Easton and Almond: Systems and Structural Functions

15. The five analytical models (direct reconstruction)

1. David Easton - systems analysis

- **Claim:** the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing **inputs** (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a **conversion process** (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into **outputs** (policies, decisions), which generate **feedback** that reshapes future demands and supports.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** stability is explained by the system's capacity to convert demands into outputs faster than demands accumulate, and by supports (loyalty, legitimacy, taxes, compliance) that keep the conversion process running.
- **Significance:** allows comparison across very different polities using one common vocabulary (inputs/outputs/feedback), and foregrounds system persistence and adaptation.
- **Limit:** criticised as too static/equilibrium-biased; weak at explaining the internal distribution of power, ideology, or discontinuous change such as revolution, and thin on why particular actors win particular conflicts.

2. Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach

- **Claim:** every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal **functions** (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different **structures** in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).
- **Evidence/mechanism:** comparing systems by function rather than by formal institutional labels lets scholars compare, say, a parliamentary democracy and a traditional chiefdom on the same functional grid.
- **Significance:** widened comparative politics beyond formal constitutions to informal structures, especially useful for newly independent/developing polities whose formal institutions may not match Western templates.
- **Limit:** functionalism's assumption that systems tend toward equilibrium risks a conservative bias (downplaying conflict and structural change), and in practice often measured non-Western systems against a Western liberal-democratic benchmark despite the framework's own claim to be structure-neutral.

Visual-first recall

EASTON AND ALMOND: SYSTEMS AND STRUCTURAL FUNCTIONS

- |
- [1] Claim: the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider...
- v
- [2] Evidence/mechanism: stability is explained by the system's capacity to convert...
- v
- [3] Significance: allows comparison across very different polities using one common...
- v
- [4] Limit: criticised as too static/equilibrium-biased; weak at explaining the internal...

Answer-grabbing line: Claim: the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion.

Must-write keywords: David Easton - systems analysis; Claim::; inputs; conversion process; outputs; feedback; Evidence/mechanism:.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Claim: the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion process (legislatures, parties, bureaucracy) into outputs (policies, decisions), which generate feedback that reshapes future demands and supports. **Named evidence/example:** Evidence/mechanism: stability is explained by the system's capacity to convert demands into outputs faster than demands accumulate, and by supports (loyalty, legitimacy, taxes, compliance) that keep the conversion process running. **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how easton and almond: systems and

structural functions shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Limit: criticised as too static/equilibrium-biased; weak at explaining the internal distribution of power, ideology, or discontinuous change such as revolution, and thin on why particular actors win particular conflicts.

SESSION 9 - Deutsch, Decision-Making, Marxian Analysis and Model Comparison

3. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach

- **Claim:** government functions like a **steering mechanism**, and politics can be modelled on cybernetics (the science of communication and control) - decision-making depends on the flow of information through communication channels, with feedback loops correcting the system's course toward its goals.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** concepts such as information "load," "lag," "gain" and "lead" describe how efficiently a political system receives, processes and acts on information about the gap between its goals and its actual performance.
- **Significance:** foregrounds learning, error-correction and adaptive capacity in political systems, useful for analysing bureaucratic responsiveness and policy feedback.
- **Limit:** the mechanistic/engineering metaphor understates power, ideology and class conflict, and is not well suited to explaining revolution, resource allocation battles or the use of violence.

4. Decision-making approach

- **Claim:** political outcomes are best explained by identifying the **decision-makers**, the **alternatives** before them, and the **information, values and organisational setting** that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** decision-making frameworks (e.g. those used in foreign-policy analysis) break a decision into stages - problem recognition, search for alternatives, evaluation, choice, and implementation - and examine the internal organisational context of the deciding body.
- **Significance:** useful for tracing why one policy alternative rather than another was actually chosen, spotlighting individuals and institutions as choosers rather than treating outcomes as automatic system outputs.
- **Limit:** can become narrowly focused on the moment of decision, losing sight of long-term structural forces (class, economy, ideology) that pre-shape which alternatives even reach the table; risks elite bias by concentrating only on visible decision-makers.

5. Marxian approach

- **Claim:** politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a **superstructure** resting on, and reproducing, the economic **base**/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.
- **Evidence/mechanism:** analysis of who owns and controls the means of production is used to explain apparently neutral political institutions (law, bureaucracy, even ideology) as expressions of underlying class interest.
- **Significance:** exposes hidden class interests behind formally neutral institutions and connects political analysis directly to economic structure.
- **Limit:** reductionist - denies political institutions and ideas any independent causal weight of their own; struggles to explain variation among different capitalist states with similar economic structures but very different politics; its historical predictions about revolutionary transition remain contested and should be treated as book-period theoretical claims, not settled fact. (PDF pp.133-134, per the advanced companion's reconstruction)

16. Comparing the five models and their limitations

Model	Core unit of analysis	Main strength	Main limitation
Systems (Easton)	Inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback	Cross-system comparison; explains persistence/stability	Weak on power distribution and revolutionary change
Structural-functional (Almond)	Functions performed by variable structures	Compares formal and informal/traditional structures	Conservative/equilibrium bias; implicit Western benchmark
Communications/cybernetic (Deutsch)	Information flow and feedback	Explains learning, adaptation, error-correction	Understates power, ideology, class conflict
Decision-making	Decision-makers, alternatives, choice process	Explains specific policy choices	Narrow focus; elite bias; misses structural forces
Marxian	Economic base and class relations	Exposes hidden class interest in institutions	Reductionist; weak on inter-capitalist variation

- ANALYSIS: Exam framing: no single model is "correct" - Gauba's own comparative stance (echoed in Section 8 above for the traditional/behavioural/post-behavioural clusters) extends here: each model highlights different variables (stability, function, communication, choice, or class) and is chosen according to the question asked, not treated as a universal master key.

Visual-first recall

DEUTSCH, DECISION-MAKING, MARXIAN ANALYSIS AND MODEL COMPARISON

```

|
[1] Model - Core unit of analysis - Main strength - Main limitation
v
[2] Systems (Easton) - Inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback - Cross-system comparison;...
v
[3] Structural-functional (Almond) - Functions performed by variable structures - ...
v
[4] Communications/cybernetic (Deutsch) - Information flow and feedback - Explains...

```

Answer-grabbing line: Model - Core unit of analysis - Main strength - Main limitation

Must-write keywords: Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach; Claim;; steering mechanism; Evidence/mechanism;; Significance;; Limit;; Decision-making approach.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: Model - Core unit of analysis - Main strength - Main limitation **Named evidence/example:** Systems (Easton) - Inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback - Cross-system comparison; explains persistence/stability - Weak on power distribution and revolutionary change **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how deutsch, decision-making, marxian analysis and model comparison shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Model - Core unit of analysis - Main strength - Main limitation

SESSION 10 - Objections, Indian Application and Mark-Scaled Answers

17. Two objection-reply chains

1. **Objection:** behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a value-laden act.

Reply: post-behaviouralism (Easton) does not abandon science in response; it insists that knowledge must be made relevant and put to responsible use while retaining verification and rigour - "action" is added to, not substituted for, evidence standards. (PDF pp.121-122)

2. **Objection:** structural-functionalism's claim to be structure-neutral is not honoured in practice - comparative studies routinely measure non-Western/developing polities against an implicit Western liberal-democratic template and label divergence as "underdevelopment."

Reply: defenders reply that the framework's functional categories (interest articulation, aggregation, rule-making, etc.) are, by design, meant to be filled by any structure - formal parties or informal kinship/patron-client networks alike - so the bias is a failure of *application*, not of the model's own logic; critics maintain the correction is inconsistently applied in comparative practice. ANALYSIS: Present both sides; do not resolve the debate as settled.

18. Cautious Indian application

- ANALYSIS: The decision-making approach can be used to analyse how an Indian policy choice (e.g. a Cabinet or Cabinet Committee decision) moves from problem recognition to implementation, without asserting unverified specifics of any particular real decision unless independently confirmed.
- ANALYSIS: The structural-functional approach can compare India's formal parliamentary structures with informal interest-articulation channels (caste associations, kinship networks, local patron-client ties) performing the same function in different areas - cite this as a *type* of comparison, not with unverified statistics.
- ANALYSIS: The systems model can be used to trace how a sustained public demand (e.g. a farmers' agitation) moves through the input-conversion-output-feedback cycle into policy - use as a conceptual illustration, not as a claim about any specific outcome unless separately verified.

19. Executable answer architecture (10/15 marks)

Directive decoding

- "Discuss behaviouralism as an approach to political analysis" -> requires definition + the eight tenets (at least several named) + a limitation, not a one-line description.
- "Explain any one model of political analysis" -> single-model directive: give claim, mechanism, significance and limitation for that one model only; do not pad with unrelated models.
- "Compare/Distinguish [any two models]" -> comparison directive: use the comparison table logic (unit of analysis, strength, limitation) explicitly for both named models.

10-mark architecture (~150 words)

1. Thesis: political inquiry has moved from traditional/normative approaches to a scientific, and then a value-conscious, contemporary approach.
2. Body: name behaviouralism's core aim + 2-3 of the eight tenets, or reconstruct one analytical model with claim->evidence->significance.
3. One limitation.
4. One-line conclusion.

15-mark architecture (~200-250 words)

1. Thesis + directive decoding.
 2. Doctrine reconstruction: method vs approach -> empirical vs normative -> traditional approaches in one line -> behaviouralism's eight tenets (name at least four) -> post-behaviouralism's relevance/action correction.
 3. Reconstruct one analytical model in full (claim->evidence->significance->limit).
 4. One objection-reply chain.
 5. Reasoned conclusion.
1. Thesis + directive decoding.
 2. Full doctrine reconstruction: method/approach, empirical/normative, traditional approaches, behaviouralism's eight tenets, post-behaviouralism.
 3. Reconstruct at least two analytical models (e.g. Easton's systems model and Almond's structural-functional approach, or Deutsch's cybernetic model and the Marxian approach) with claim->evidence->significance->limit each, plus the comparison table's logic.
 4. Two objection-reply chains (value-neutrality objection; structural-functional Western-benchmark objection).
 5. Cautious Indian application (one example, correctly hedged).
 6. Graded conclusion on why political science needs both scientific rigour and relevance/value-consciousness.

Quotation/proposition method

- Prefer named propositions over unverified verbatim quotations, e.g. "*Easton's proposition that political science should integrate scientific rigour with relevance and action*" rather than an exact quoted sentence, unless independently verified.

Visual-first recall

OBJECTIONS, INDIAN APPLICATION AND MARK-SCALED ANSWERS

- |
- [1] 1. Objection: behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it...
- v
- [2] Reply: post-behaviouralism (Easton) does not abandon science in response; it insists...
- v
- [3] 2. Objection: structural-functionalism's claim to be structure-neutral is not...
- v
- [4] Reply: defenders reply that the framework's functional categories (interest...

Answer-grabbing line: 1. Objection: behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a value-laden act.

Must-write keywords: Objection;; Reply;; Objections; Indian Application; Mark-Scaled Answers; SESSION; Objection.

Claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification demonstration

Claim: 1. Objection: behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a value-laden act. **Named evidence/example:** Reply: post-behaviouralism (Easton) does not abandon science in response; it insists that knowledge must be made relevant and put to responsible use while retaining verification and rigour - "action" is added to, not substituted for, evidence standards. (PDF pp.121-122) **Analysis:** Read together, these propositions show how objections, indian application and mark-scaled answers shapes approaches, behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism rather than serving as a detachable list of names. **Qualification:** Reply: post-behaviouralism (Easton) does not abandon science in response; it insists that knowledge must be made relevant and put to responsible use while retaining verification and rigour - "action" is added to, not substituted for, evidence standards. (PDF pp.121-122)

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

The following text-native master is identical to the standalone ASCII artifact.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/17: GS/Prelims Boundary

GS/PRELIMS BOUNDARY
01. TARGET: UPSC Prelims + General Studies Mains only.
v
02. PRIMARY USE: GS-II conceptual foundations.
v
03. TOPIC SCOPE: Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism.
v
04. Sections 13-19 of this file already reconstruct the eight behavioural tenets and all five analytical models (Easton, Almond, Deutsch, decision-making, Marxian) with claim
v
05. ADVANCED label = enrichment beyond a core GS answer, not an exam-paper label.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/17: Origin and Dated Rail (1/2)

ORIGIN AND DATED RAIL (1/2)
01. 1859 -> Preface to A Contribution to the Critique of Political Economy
v
02. 1921 -> Study of Politics' published in American Political Science Review
v
03. 1925 -> New Aspects of Politics
v
04. 1925 -> American Political Science Association
v
05. 1927 -> Catlin, in his Science and Method of Politics

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/17: Origin and Dated Rail (2/2)

ORIGIN AND DATED RAIL (2/2)
06. 1936 -> Who Gets What, When, How
v
07. 1953 -> Weldon, in his Vocabulary of Politics
v
08. 1962 -> Thomas Kuhn's The Structure of Scientific Revolutions
v
09. 1966 -> A Developmental Approach

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/17: Core Definitions

CORE DEFINITIONS
01. METHOD: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained. (PDF p.108)
02. APPROACH: A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data. (PDF pp.108-109)
03. EMPIRICAL STATEMENT: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or

verified by repeated observation. (PDF pp.110-111)

04. NORMATIVE STATEMENT: A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed. (PDF pp.110-112)

05. BEHAVIOURALISM: A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups. (PDF pp.118-121)

06. POST-BEHAVIOURALISM: A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values. (PDF pp.121-122)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/17: Chapter Spine (1/2)

CHAPTER SPINE (1/2)

01. Gauba begins by separating method from approach so that students do not confuse tools of inquiry with frames of inquiry. (PDF pp.108-109)

v

02. He then warns that traditional/contemporary and normative/empirical are not identical pairs. (PDF pp.109-110)

v

03. He clarifies that empirical vs normative turns on the content of the claim, not just the grammatical presence of "is" or "ought". (PDF pp.110-112)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/17: Chapter Spine (2/2)

CHAPTER SPINE (2/2)

04. The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)

v

05. The contemporary shift is marked by behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and several models of political analysis. (PDF pp.117-134)

v

06. The chapter's deeper message is integrative: political science is weakened both by value-blind technique and by unsupported moral assertion

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/17: Thinkers and Named Positions (1)

THINKERS AND NAMED POSITIONS (1)

01. VERNON VAN DYKE: Clarifies the distinction between approach and method and explains philosophical analysis as conceptual clarification plus evaluation. (PDF pp.108-109, 113)

02. LEO STRAUSS: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality. (PDF pp.112, 114, 121)

03. GRAHAM WALLAS AND ARTHUR BENTLEY: Early forerunners of behaviouralism who shift attention toward actual behaviour and informal processes. (PDF p.118)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/17: Thinkers and Named Positions (2)

THINKERS AND NAMED POSITIONS (2)

01. CHARLES MERRIAM: Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinarity and behavioural inquiry. (PDF pp.118-119)

02. HAROLD LASSWELL: Develops politics as the analysis of power and policy. (PDF p.119)

03. DAVID EASTON: Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action. (PDF pp.120-122)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/17: Illustrations Attached to Claims

ILLUSTRATIONS ATTACHED TO CLAIMS

01. "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)

02. "Justice is treating equals equally..." is normative in content even though it appears

| in the form of an "is" statement. (PDF p.110)

| 03. Legal analysis of Indian politics would ask what constitutional provisions authorize institutions and actions. (PDF pp.115-116)

| 04. Institutional analysis would map legislature, executive, judiciary, parties and their formal relations. (PDF pp.116-117)

| 05. Behavioural analysis of the same political scene would ask how voters, leaders, parties and interest groups actually behave

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/17: Comparison Matrix

COMPARISON MATRIX

| 01. TRADITIONAL | Core claim = Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions. (PDF pp.109-117) | Main focus = Concepts, thought, legal framework, institutions. (PDF pp.113-117) | Limitation flagged by Gauba = Often descriptive or normative without enough behavioural/process analysis. (PDF pp.117-118)

| 02. BEHAVIOURAL | Core claim = Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121) | Main focus = Individuals, attitudes, participation, communication, decision-processes. (PDF pp.119-121) | Limitation flagged by Gauba = Risk of excessive micro-focus, method-fetish and value-neutral distance from urgent public issues. (PDF pp.121-122)

| 03. POST-BEHAVIOURAL | Core claim = Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction. (PDF pp.121-122) | Main focus = Social problems, public responsibility, applied knowledge. (PDF pp.121-122) | Limitation flagged by Gauba = It must not become a licence for untested moralism; relevance still needs disciplined inquiry

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/17: Examiner Trap Firewall

EXAMINER TRAP FIREWALL

| 01. TRAP: Method and approach are synonyms => REPAIR: Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

| 02. TRAP: Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical => REPAIR: Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)

| 03. TRAP: Any sentence with "ought" is normative => REPAIR: Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)

| 04. TRAP: Value-free means politically consequence-free => REPAIR: Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)

| 05. TRAP: Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism => REPAIR: Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/17: Ownership Boundaries and Cross-Links

OWNERSHIP BOUNDARIES AND CROSS-LINKS

| 01. Sections 13-19 of this file already reconstruct the eight behavioural tenets and all five analytical models (Easton, Almond, Deutsch, decision-making, Marxian) with claim->evidence->significance->limit; use Political-Theory/advanced/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md only for further comparative depth and extra answer-engine prompts, not as a requirement for full marks

| 02. Read Political-Theory/basic/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md first if the nature of politics itself is unclear

| 03. Use Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md for the module-wide theory/science decode engine

| 04. Use Political-Theory/README.md for the topic map and tag policy

| 05. Boundary: this file explains ways of studying politics; it does not duplicate detailed constitutional or public-administration content

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 13/17: Revision Capsule

REVISION CAPSULE

| 01. Method = procedure; approach = procedure plus problem/data selection. (PDF pp.108-109)

v

| 02. Empirical vs normative depends on content, not grammar alone. (PDF pp.110-112)

	v	
03. Traditional approaches: philosophical, historical, legal, institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)		
	v	
04. Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)		
	v	
05. Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)		
	v	
06. Best answer line: political inquiry needs both disciplined evidence and defensible value judgment		

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/17: Answer-Grabbing Line Bank

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE BANK
01. Method means procedure of inquiry; approach means procedure plus criteria for selecting problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
02. Term - Exam-ready meaning
03. Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)
04. "Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work" is empirical in content because its claim can be checked against political functioning. (PDF pp.110-111)
05. Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
06. These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to David Easton's account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's own 1969 listing). Treat
07. Post-behaviouralism is a corrective within science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism
08. Claim: the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion
09. Model - Core unit of analysis - Main strength - Main limitation
10. 1. Objection: behavioural political science's value-neutrality claim makes it complicit in ignoring urgent injustice, since choosing what to study/ignore is itself a value-laden act

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 15/17: Must-Write Keyword Bank

MUST-WRITE KEYWORD BANK
01. Subject;; Tier;; Exam relevance;; Core area;; Grounded in;; Source edition/cutoff;; Method
02. Empirical; Normative Inquiry; Content; SESSION; Essential; Term; Exam-ready
03. Traditional Approaches; Their Thinkers; SESSION; Essential; Method; Traditional; Empirical
04. Illustrations; Comparison; Trap Repair; SESSION; Illustrative; Everybody; Justice
05. Boundaries; Revision; Source Discipline; SESSION; UPSC; Method; Approach
06. David Easton; Regularities; Verification; Techniques; Quantification; Values; Systematization
07. relevance; action; Post-Behavioural Relevance; Action; SESSION; Post-behaviouralism; Easton
08. David Easton - systems analysis; Claim;; inputs; conversion process; outputs; feedback; Evidence/mechanism:
09. Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach; Claim;; steering mechanism; Evidence/mechanism;; Significance;; Limit;; Decision-making approach
10. Objection;; Reply;; Objections; Indian Application; Mark-Scaled Answers; SESSION; Objection

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/17: GS Mains Question Routes

GS MAINS QUESTION ROUTES

01. 10 MARKS: Distinguish method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in 150 words
02. 10 MARKS: Why must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form? Answer in 150 words
03. 10 MARKS: Examine behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science. Answer in 150 words
04. 15 MARKS: Evaluate post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism. Answer in 250 words
05. 15 MARKS: Compare the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis. Answer in 250 words
06. 15 MARKS: Can political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism. Answer in 250 words

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 17/17: Qualified Verdict and Answer Spine

QUALIFIED VERDICT AND ANSWER SPINE
01. Open with the boundary line, not with a general definition. v
02. Carry the argument on named evidence taken from the thinker panels. v
03. Insert the trap-firewall distinction that the question is testing. v
04. Add the objection or limitation before concluding. v
05. CLOSE: These eight "tenets"/"intellectual foundation stones" are commonly attributed, via Gauba's exposition, to David Easton's account of behaviouralism (echoing Easton's own 1969 listing). Treat. Claim: the political system is best understood as an open system embedded in a wider social environment, processing inputs (demands and supports from citizens/groups) through a conversion. The mark therefore comes from the qualification: state the strongest case, then the limit at which it stops being defensible

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Method**?

- A. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- B. political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- C. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- D. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Method.
- **B:** B Attaches to Integration, not Method.
- **C:** C Attaches to Regularities, not Method.
- **D:** D Attaches to Verification, not Method.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Method by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Approach**?

- A. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- C. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- D. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Normative statement, not Approach.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Approach.
- **C:** C Attaches to Post-behaviouralism, not Approach.
- **D:** D Attaches to Post-behavioural, not Approach.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Approach by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Empirical statement**?

- A. research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- B. precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- C. A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
- D. rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Systematization, not Empirical statement.
- **B:** B Attaches to Quantification, not Empirical statement.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Empirical statement.
- **D:** D Attaches to Techniques, not Empirical statement.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Empirical statement by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Normative statement**?

- A. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- B. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- C. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- D. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Post-behaviouralism, not Normative statement.
- **B:** B Attaches to Approach, not Normative statement.
- **C:** C Attaches to Post-behavioural, not Normative statement.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Normative statement.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Normative statement by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Behaviouralism**?

- A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
- B. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- C. Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
- D. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Behaviouralism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Values, not Behaviouralism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Leo Strauss, not Behaviouralism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Pure science, not Behaviouralism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Behaviouralism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Post-behaviouralism**?

- A. A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- B. A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- C. A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- D. Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Approach, not Post-behaviouralism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Post-behaviouralism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Normative statement, not Post-behaviouralism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Post-behavioural, not Post-behaviouralism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Post-behaviouralism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Traditional**?

- A. those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- B. political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- C. Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.
- D. The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Verification, not Traditional.
- **B:** B Attaches to Regularities, not Traditional.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Traditional.
- **D:** D Attaches to Method, not Traditional.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Traditional by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Behavioural**?

- A. A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
- B. understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.
- C. an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- D. Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Behaviouralism, not Behavioural.

- **B:** B Attaches to Pure science, not Behavioural.
- **C:** C Attaches to Values, not Behavioural.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Behavioural.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Behavioural by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Post-behavioural - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- B. Approach - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- C. Normative statement - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- D. Post-behaviouralism - Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Records the association: Post-behavioural is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Approach is recorded with A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Normative statement is recorded with A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Post-behaviouralism is recorded with A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Post-behavioural; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Method - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- B. Regularities - political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- C. Verification - political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- D. Traditional - A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Method is recorded with The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- **B:** B Matches the record: Regularities is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Verification is recorded with those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Traditional is recorded with Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Regularities; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Method - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- B. Regularities - political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- C. Verification - those generalisations must be testable against relevant, observable behaviour.
- D. Traditional - A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: Method is recorded with The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Regularities is recorded with political behaviour shows uniformities expressible as generalisations/theories.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Verification is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Traditional is recorded with Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Verification; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Approach - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- B. Systematization - A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- C. David Easton - A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
- D. Techniques - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Approach is recorded with A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Systematization is recorded with research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- **C:** C Mismatched: David Easton is recorded with Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.
- **D:** D Correct attachment: Techniques is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Techniques; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Quantification - precision through measurement and quantification wherever the data meaningfully allow it.
- B. Empirical statement - rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- C. Integration - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- D. Method - Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: Quantification is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Empirical statement is recorded with A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Integration is recorded with political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Method is recorded with The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Quantification; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Pure science - Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
- B. Values - an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- C. Behavioural - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- D. Behaviouralism - A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Pure science is recorded with understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.
- **B:** B Correct attachment: Values is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Behavioural is recorded with Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Behaviouralism is recorded with A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Values; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Approach - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction.
- B. Techniques - A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
- C. Systematization - research and theory are interdependent; data collection is guided by, and in turn refines, theory.
- D. David Easton - A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Approach is recorded with A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Techniques is recorded with rigorous tools and methods (surveys, statistics, sampling) are used to acquire and interpret data.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Systematization is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: David Easton is recorded with Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Systematization; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Behavioural - Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
- B. Behaviouralism - A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data; the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.
- C. Values - Science should remain rigorous but also relevant, action-oriented and attentive to value-construction; this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- D. Pure science - understanding and explanation of political behaviour is treated as logically prior to its application in solving urgent social problems.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Behavioural is recorded with Political science should study actual political behaviour scientifically through regularities, verification, techniques and quantification.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Behaviouralism is recorded with A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Values is recorded with an analytic separation is drawn between empirical explanation and ethical evaluation (value-neutrality as method, not indifference).
- **D:** D Records the association: Pure science is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Pure science; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Integration** is associated with: political science should integrate with, and borrow from, the other social sciences.
2. **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach** is associated with: Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Integration does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **David Easton - systems analysis** is associated with: political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.
2. **Decision-making approach** is associated with: political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with David Easton - systems analysis does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach** is associated with: every political system, regardless of its formal constitution, must perform certain universal functions (political socialization and recruitment, interest articulation, interest aggregation, rule-making, rule-application, rule-adjudication, and communication); these functions can be performed by different structures in different systems (e.g. interest articulation via parties in one system, via kinship or patron-client networks in another).
2. **Marxian approach** is associated with: politics has no autonomous existence; political institutions and ideas form part of a superstructure resting on, and reproducing, the economic base/mode of production and its class relations - the state, in class society, is an instrument of the dominant class.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Gabriel Almond - structural-functional approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach** is associated with: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
2. **Leo Strauss** is associated with: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Karl Deutsch - communication/cybernetic approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Decision-making approach** is associated with: political outcomes are best explained by identifying the decision-makers, the alternatives before them, and the information, values and organisational setting that shape which alternative is chosen - attention shifts from abstract "the state decided" to the actual unit and process of choice.
2. **David Easton** is associated with: A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Decision-making approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Marxian approach** is associated with: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
2. **Method** is associated with: The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Marxian approach does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Leo Strauss** is associated with: Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
2. **Approach** is associated with: A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Leo Strauss does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **David Easton** is associated with: A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
2. **Empirical statement** is associated with: Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with David Easton does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Method and approach are synonyms.?**

- A. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- B. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- C. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- D. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Method and approach are synonyms, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical.?**

- A. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- B. Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)
- C. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- D. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Traditional always means normative, and contemporary, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Any sentence with "ought" is normative.**?

- A. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- B. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- C. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- D. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Any sentence with "ought" is normative, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Value-free means politically consequence-free.**?

- A. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122); the other dimensions would remain secondary under this reading.
- B. Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- C. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122); this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- D. Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Approach means Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Value-free means politically consequence-free, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.?**

- A. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
- B. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- C. Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
- D. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Approach means Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.?**

- A. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- B. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- C. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
- D. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Method means A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.**?

- A. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- B. Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
- C. Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- D. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Method and approach are synonyms.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Method means The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Method means A corrective within behavioural, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Approach means Politics is illuminated through philosophy, history, law and institutions.**?

- A. Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
- B. Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
- C. Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)
- D. Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Any sentence with "ought" is normative.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Approach means A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Approach means Politics is illuminated through, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Approaches, Behaviouralism and Post-Behaviouralism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive distinguish requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Method, Core and Conclusion, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable.

Model answer (138 words):

Introduction: Method and approach both organise inquiry, but they operate at different levels. Core analysis: A method is a procedure for obtaining, testing and interpreting knowledge, such as observation, comparison, historical reconstruction or statistical analysis. An approach is wider: it includes methods but also criteria for selecting the problem, relevant actors, admissible data and explanatory variables. A behavioural approach, for example, directs attention toward observable conduct and may then use surveys or quantification as methods. A philosophical approach selects conceptual coherence and normative justification as central problems and uses argument as a method. Yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable. Conclusion: The distinction matters because method governs the reliability of inquiry, whereas approach also governs its intellectual agenda by deciding which problems, actors and evidence become visible.

Why this earns marks: it obeys distinguish instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Method, Core and Conclusion), converts that evidence into analysis of method from approach in political inquiry and explain why the distinction matters, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that yet the distinction remains analytically useful: approaches set the agenda, while methods make investigation disciplined and publicly testable. At 138 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Empirical, Core and Gauba's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively.

Model answer (134 words):

Introduction: Empirical and normative statements differ by the kind of claim they make, not simply by whether their wording contains 'is' or 'ought'. Core analysis: An empirical statement describes an observable relation that can be checked through evidence, repetition or consequences. A normative statement expresses a value, obligation or preferred order and requires moral justification. Gauba's examples expose the grammatical trap. 'Everybody ought to vote if democracy is to work' can be empirical in content because the proposed condition may be tested against democratic functioning. Correct classification requires asking whether the claim is verifiable, evaluative or a

combination requiring both forms of reasoning. Conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Empirical, Core and Gauba's), converts that evidence into analysis of must empirical and normative statements be classified by content rather than grammatical form, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Political analysis must test what kind of claim is being made rather than searching mechanically for 'is' or 'ought', because factual conditions can be phrased prescriptively and value judgments descriptively. At 134 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Examine behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive examine requires the answer to test the proposition rather than describe it, weighing what supports and what weakens it. Fix the boundary of behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Behaviouralism, Core and Eastonian, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them.

Model answer (141 words):

Introduction: Behaviouralism reoriented political science toward the systematic study of actual political behaviour rather than exclusive reliance on formal institutions or inherited texts. Core analysis: Its commonly taught Eastonian tenets are regularities, verification, techniques, quantification, value separation, systematization, pure science and integration. Regularities make generalisation possible; verification tests claims against observation; techniques and quantification improve precision; value separation distinguishes empirical explanation from ethical judgment; systematization connects theory and research; pure science gives explanation logical priority over application; and integration opens political science to other social sciences. Wallas, Bentley, Merriam and Lasswell prepared this movement by studying psychology, groups, power and policy. Scientific rigour enlarged political knowledge, but could not decide which questions deserved priority. Conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them.

Why this earns marks: it obeys examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Behaviouralism, Core and Eastonian), converts that evidence into analysis of behaviouralism's eight tenets and its contribution to political science, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Behaviouralism made political inquiry more systematic, verifiable and interdisciplinary, but its scientific contribution remains defensible only when technique serves significant political questions rather than replacing them. At 141 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Post-behaviouralism, Core and Easton's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that it does not replace verification with conviction.

Model answer (238 words):

Introduction: Post-behaviouralism arose from dissatisfaction with behavioural political science's retreat into tractable method while public crises demanded responsible knowledge. Core analysis: Easton's correction preserved behaviouralism's achievements-regularities, verification, rigorous technique and empirical explanation-but added relevance and action. Relevance requires research to address significant problems such as war, poverty, discrimination and injustice instead of selecting questions only because they are easily measured. Action requires

scholars to accept responsibility for applying knowledge toward social betterment. The movement also made value choice explicit: deciding what to study and whom research serves cannot be treated as politically innocent. Further development: Its correction also changes the scholar's role. Behavioural detachment protects research from propaganda, but detachment cannot mean indifference to how knowledge is selected or used. Relevance identifies important public problems, action connects findings to possible remedies, and value-consciousness requires explicit justification of ends. The residual danger is that urgency may reward weak evidence or ideological certainty. Post-behaviouralism succeeds only when public responsibility is joined to reproducible inquiry and critical scrutiny. Critical evaluation: This is not permission for unsupported activism. Evidence standards remain necessary, and a fashionable cause does not validate weak analysis. Post-behaviouralism corrects the purpose and public orientation of science; it does not replace verification with conviction. Its durable position is therefore a synthesis of rigour, relevance and accountable action. Conclusion: Post-behaviouralism is best understood as value-conscious science: it retains verification and technique while restoring relevance, action and public responsibility.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Post-behaviouralism, Core and Easton's), converts that evidence into analysis of post-behaviouralism as a correction of, rather than a rejection of, behaviouralism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that it does not replace verification with conviction. At 238 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Compare the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Easton's and Almond's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously.

Model answer (248 words):

Introduction: The five models organise political explanation around different units and mechanisms, so comparison must ask what each reveals and conceals. Core analysis: Easton's systems analysis traces demands and supports through conversion into outputs and feedback, explaining persistence and adaptation. Almond's structural-functional model compares the universal functions performed by different formal or informal structures. Deutsch's communications model treats government as a steering process dependent on information flow, load, lag and corrective feedback. Decision-making analysis reconstructs who chose among which alternatives under particular informational, value and organisational constraints. Marxian analysis locates institutions and ideas within the economic base, class relations and dominant interests. Further development: Model choice should follow the explanatory problem. A demand moving through institutions is suited to Easton's input-output-feedback cycle; comparison across unlike formal structures is suited to Almond's functional grid; bureaucratic learning is illuminated by Deutsch's information flows; a discrete policy choice requires decision-process reconstruction; and concealed ownership power calls for Marxian analysis. Objections also differ: systems and functionalism are criticised for stability bias, communications for underplaying conflict, decision-making for ignoring pre-structured alternatives, and Marxism for economic reductionism. Triangulating models can test whether one model's omitted variable changes the conclusion, but models cannot simply be stacked without a clear causal sequence. Their strengths are therefore conditional, not cumulative proof of one master model. Conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Easton's and Almond's), converts that evidence into analysis of the systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian models of political analysis, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: The five models should be treated as complementary but limited lenses: each identifies a different causal mechanism, and no one model can explain stability, function, information, choice and class power simultaneously. At 248 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Can political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive can requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Behaviouralism and Strauss, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends.

Model answer (241 words):

Introduction: The ideal of value-free political science seeks to protect factual explanation from the researcher's moral preferences, but it cannot remove values from every stage of inquiry. Core analysis: Behaviouralism usefully separates empirical propositions from ethical evaluation and demands verification, regularity and disciplined technique. This prevents desired conclusions from substituting for evidence. Strauss objects that political inquiry cannot understand tyranny, justice or the good regime while refusing to judge values; selection of politically important problems already presupposes standards of significance. Post-behaviouralism converts that criticism into methodological reform: research must retain scientific rigour while becoming relevant, action-oriented and conscious of its public consequences. Further development: The empirical-normative distinction should be preserved even when complete neutrality is rejected. Whether turnout changed, an institution complied with a rule or an attitude correlates with behaviour remains an evidential question. Whether participation is adequate, compliance legitimate or an attitude unjust requires evaluative reasons. Strauss protects the latter inquiry; behaviouralism disciplines the former; post-behaviouralism asks how the two can address public problems together. The remaining danger is ideological capture, where relevance becomes an excuse to predetermine findings. Transparent question selection, replicable evidence, explicit value premises and openness to criticism provide a stronger settlement than either scientific withdrawal or untested activism. Value control is possible; complete value absence is not. Conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Behaviouralism and Strauss), converts that evidence into analysis of political science be value-free? Discuss with reference to behaviouralism, Strauss and post-behaviouralism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Political science can discipline factual inquiry against partisan assertion, but it cannot become value-free in its choice of problems, interpretation of significance or judgment of political ends. At 241 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Political Theory | **Tier:** Advanced enrichment | **Exam relevance:** UPSC Prelims and GS Mains, primarily GS-II. This universal label means enrichment beyond a core GS answer and never a separate-paper classification. **Core area:** Competing ways of studying politics-from philosophical and institutional inquiry to behavioural science, post-behavioural relevance and analytical models. **Grounded in:** O. P. Gauba, *An Introduction to Political Theory*, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.4, PDF pp.108-134. **Source edition/cutoff:** Fifth Edition (2009); no post-2009 fact is assumed unless independently dated and tagged CURRENT:. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference/synthesis | **CURRENT:** = dated current anchor | **WRONG:** = trap/misattribution. *Companion:* Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md.

1. One-screen advanced map

- FACT: Gauba separates method from approach, then empirical from normative, before classifying the main approaches. (PDF pp.108-112)
- FACT: Traditional approaches centre on philosophy, history, law and institutions. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: Behaviouralism reorients the discipline toward observable political behaviour, scientific procedure and interdisciplinary tools. (PDF pp.118-121)
- FACT: Post-behaviouralism criticizes the withdrawal into pure method and adds relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: Political analysis then branches into systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian analysis. (PDF pp.122-134)
- ANALYSIS: Topic 08 is the methodological hinge of the module because it tells you how every later topic may be investigated differently.

2. Scope, assumptions and conceptual boundary

- FACT: This chapter is about approaches to inquiry, not a direct substantive theory of liberty, justice or the state. (PDF pp.108-134)
- FACT: Gauba warns against equating empirical with contemporary or normative with traditional in a rigid way. (PDF pp.109-110)
- FACT: He ends by refusing a complete estrangement between empirical and normative inquiry. (PDF p.112)
- ANALYSIS: Conceptually, this topic builds on the module's theory/philosophy/science distinction as mapped in Political-Theory/README.md and organized in Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md.
- ANALYSIS: Boundary: the models here are presented as tools of analysis, not as timeless proofs that one method must replace all others.

3. Direct-book argument reconstruction

- FACT: Gauba begins with conceptual hygiene: method concerns how to inquire, whereas approach concerns both how and what to inquire into. (PDF pp.108-109)
- FACT: He then historicizes the field: pre-Second-World-War approaches are called traditional, while later approaches are contemporary, but this is not the same as facts-versus-values. (PDF pp.109-110)
- FACT: Next he clarifies empirical and normative inquiry by content, showing that verification, sense-experience and instrumental value differ from moral preference and intrinsic value. (PDF pp.110-112)
- FACT: He reconstructs the traditional cluster through four approaches: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
- FACT: He then narrates behaviouralism as a post-war American movement with earlier roots in Wallas, Bentley and Merriam, eventually summarized by Easton's eight tenets. (PDF pp.118-121)
- FACT: The post-behavioural revolution is presented as Easton's internal correction: keep science, but reconnect it to public crises, values and action. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: Finally, Gauba extends the contemporary chapter into models of analysis-systems, structural-functional, communications, decision-making and Marxian analysis-each highlighting different variables. (PDF pp.122-134)

4. Definitions and distinctions

Distinction	Advanced note
Method / approach	FACT: Methods obtain and use data; approaches choose problems and relevant data as well. (PDF pp.108-109)
Traditional / contemporary	FACT: A historical distinction about dominant styles of inquiry, not a perfect facts-values binary. (PDF pp.109-110)
Empirical / normative	FACT: Empirical claims are observable and testable; normative claims express preferred orders or moral principles. (PDF pp.110-112)

Distinction	Advanced note
Form / content	FACT: Gauba explicitly shows that the wording "is" or "ought" cannot by itself classify a statement. (PDF pp.110-111)
Value-neutral / value-indifferent	ANALYSIS: Behaviouralism aimed at separating empirical explanation from ethical evaluation, but Gauba's post-behavioural section shows that this never meant the discipline could ignore the consequences of what it chose to study or neglect.

5. Thinker-by-thinker positions

Thinker	Position in this topic
Vernon Van Dyke	FACT: Defines approach as criteria of selection and philosophical analysis as clarification plus evaluation. (PDF pp.108-109, 113)
Leo Strauss	FACT: Reasserts political philosophy as knowledge of facts and standards of the good, and criticizes value-free behaviouralism. (PDF pp.112, 114, 121)
Graham Wallas	FACT: Uses psychology to challenge the overly rational image of man in politics and urges attention to actual behaviour. (PDF p.118)
Arthur Bentley	FACT: Pushes toward analysis of informal group processes rather than institutions in isolation. (PDF p.118)
Charles Merriam	FACT: Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinary borrowing and policy-science orientation. (PDF pp.118-119)
G.E.G. Catlin and Harold Lasswell	FACT: Develop value-free power analysis and politics as the study of who gets what, when, how. (PDF p.119)
David Easton	FACT: Defines behavioural tenets, then leads the post-behavioural turn and systems analysis. (PDF pp.120-125)
Gabriel Almond	FACT: Builds structural-functional analysis on the political-system framework. (PDF pp.127-129)
Karl Deutsch	FACT: Turns communication and cybernetics into a model of political analysis. (PDF pp.129-131)
Marx / Engels	FACT: Offer a non-autonomous, base-superstructure analysis in which politics must be traced to class structure. (PDF pp.133-134)

6. Competing perspectives

- FACT: Philosophical approach clarifies concepts and evaluates institutions against standards of the good, right and just. (PDF pp.113-114)
- FACT: Historical approach studies either historical laws/processes or the history of political thought in relation to its context. (PDF pp.114-115)
- FACT: Legal approach studies politics through law, constitutional framework and legally valid authority, while remaining limited in capturing informal forces. (PDF pp.115-116)
- FACT: Institutional approach studies the organization and functioning of government, parties and related institutions, yet risks over-description and neglect of informal processes. (PDF pp.116-117)
- FACT: Behaviouralism privileges observation, regularities, verification, techniques, quantification, value-neutrality, systematization, pure science and integration. (PDF pp.120-121)
- FACT: Post-behaviouralism shifts from knowledge-for-its-own-sake toward relevance, applied knowledge, action and concern with value choice. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: Marxian analysis rejects the autonomy of politics and instead studies its hidden basis in the mode of production and class struggle. (PDF pp.133-134)

7. Internal debates and criticisms

- FACT: Gauba records the criticism that behaviouralism privileges reliable micro-level questions over broader but less tractable questions. (PDF p.121)
- FACT: Post-behaviouralism arises because excessive methodological sophistication left the discipline distant from war, dictatorship, nuclear threat and urgent public crises. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: Legal and institutional approaches remain valuable, but each is limited by relative neglect of informal behaviour, violence, social forces or broader explanation. (PDF pp.116-117)
- FACT: Systems analysis is useful comparatively, yet Gauba notes its weakness in analysing political power and mass political behaviour such as voting. (PDF pp.125-126)
- FACT: Structural-functional analysis is criticized for conservatism, weak power analysis, and projecting liberal-democratic benchmarks onto developing societies. (PDF p.129)
- FACT: Communications theory is useful but limited for ideology, power structure, allocation of resources, violence and revolution. (PDF pp.130-131)
- WRONG: Post-behaviouralism allows unsupported moral assertion. -> FACT: Gauba presents it as value-conscious science, not as an escape from disciplined inquiry. (PDF pp.121-122)

8. Comparative matrix

Approach	Core question	Preferred data or unit	Strength	Limitation
Philosophical	FACT: What is right, just or conceptually coherent? (PDF pp.113-114)	FACT: Concepts, arguments, standards. (PDF pp.113-114)	FACT: Clarifies ends and critiques institutions. (PDF pp.113-114)	ANALYSIS: Cannot by itself supply behavioural verification.
Historical	FACT: How did ideas or political processes emerge over time? (PDF pp.114-115)	FACT: Past events and texts. (PDF pp.114-115)	FACT: Restores context and continuity. (PDF pp.114-115)	FACT: Risks living on inherited ideas without new synthesis. (PDF p.115)
Legal	FACT: What do laws and constitutions authorize? (PDF pp.115-116)	FACT: Legal provisions, procedures, judgments. (PDF pp.115-116)	FACT: Captures binding framework and validity. (PDF p.116)	FACT: Misses extra-legal behaviour and informal forces. (PDF p.116)
Institutional	FACT: How are political offices and agencies organized and related? (PDF pp.116-117)	FACT: Organs of government and parties. (PDF pp.116-117)	FACT: Gives politics disciplinary identity. (PDF p.116)	FACT: Over-descriptive; neglects informal processes and individuals. (PDF p.117)
Behavioural	FACT: How do actual actors behave, and what regularities can be found? (PDF pp.118-121)	FACT: Voters, leaders, attitudes, participation, quantified data. (PDF pp.119-121)	FACT: Scientific rigour and explanatory ambition. (PDF pp.120-121)	FACT: Method-heavy, micro-biased, value-neutral. (PDF pp.121-122)
Post-behavioural	FACT: How can rigorous inquiry address urgent social problems? (PDF pp.121-122)	FACT: Behavioural findings plus public problems and value questions. (PDF pp.121-122)	FACT: Relevance and action. (PDF pp.121-122)	ANALYSIS: Can be vague if relevance is asserted without analytical discipline.
Marxian	FACT: What class structure and mode of production generate politics? (PDF pp.133-134)	FACT: Economic structure, class relations, historical stages. (PDF pp.133-134)	FACT: Reveals the hidden basis of politics in class power. (PDF pp.133-134)	FACT: Refuses autonomy of politics, so it sidelines system-level analysis per se. (PDF pp.133-134)

9. Application without current-affairs dependence

- ANALYSIS: A university election can be studied philosophically by asking what fair representation requires.
- ANALYSIS: The same election can be studied historically by tracing how student institutions evolved on that campus.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied legally by examining the rules, eligibility and valid procedures.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied institutionally by mapping offices, committees and roles.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied behaviourally by surveying turnout, attitudes, campaigning and peer influence.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied post-behaviourally by asking whether that knowledge helps solve exclusion, violence or distrust in the institution.
- ANALYSIS: It can be studied through systems analysis as inputs, outputs and feedback, or through decision-making analysis by tracking who chose what among which alternatives.

10. UPSC answer-engine prompts

- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Differentiate method and approach in political science." -> Use Van Dyke first, then show why approach includes criteria of selection.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Why is empirical vs normative not identical to contemporary vs traditional?" -> Give Gauba's warning, then cite Aristotle, Marx, Rawls and Hayek as mixed cases. (PDF pp.109-110)
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Assess behaviouralism and post-behaviouralism." -> Organize by scientific gains, limits, and Easton's relevance-action correction.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Explain major models of political analysis." -> Move from Easton to Almond to Deutsch to decision-making, then contrast Marxian analysis.
- ANALYSIS: Prompt: "Can political science be value-free?" -> Use behavioural aspiration, Straussian criticism and post-behavioural synthesis.

11. Cross-links and exclusions

- ANALYSIS: Foundation companion:
`Political-Theory/basic/08_Approaches-Behaviouralism-and-Post-Behaviouralism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Substantive predecessor:
`Political-Theory/basic/07_Nature-of-Politics-and-Communitarianism.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Module framework: `Political-Theory/00_Master-Framework.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Topic map and tagging discipline: `Political-Theory/README.md`.
- ANALYSIS: Exclusion: this file does not substitute for later substantive topics on state, power, rights or democracy; it provides the lenses through which those topics can be studied.

12. Factual-risk checks

- FACT: Behaviouralism is described here in its mid-20th-century disciplinary setting as Gauba presents it; later methodological developments are not silently imported. (PDF pp.118-122)
- FACT: Easton's 1969 post-behavioural intervention is used as a dated intellectual marker inside the book's narrative, not as a present-day disciplinary status claim. (PDF pp.121-122)
- FACT: The examples about India under legal approach are examples of what legal analysis would ask, not a full contemporary constitutional handbook. (PDF pp.115-116)
- WRONG: Do not turn "value-free" into "socially innocent"; the chapter itself shows why that move provoked the post-behavioural correction. (PDF pp.121-122)

13. Sources, metadata and tags

- FACT: Primary source used directly: Gauba, Ch.4, PDF pp.108-134.
- FACT: Method/approach and empirical/normative anchor pages: PDF pp.108-112.
- FACT: Traditional approaches anchor pages: PDF pp.113-117.
- FACT: Behavioural and post-behavioural anchor pages: PDF pp.118-122.
- FACT: Analytical models anchor pages: PDF pp.122-134.
- ANALYSIS: All synthesis beyond direct paraphrase is tagged, especially where the file converts Gauba's narrative into answer-ready matrices.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Method	The procedure of inquiry by which reliable knowledge and conclusions are obtained.
Approach	A wider frame that includes method plus criteria for selecting problems, questions and relevant data.
Empirical statement	A claim about an observable situation that can be tested or verified by repeated observation.
Normative statement	A claim expressing a preference, duty or moral principle about what ought to be valued or prescribed.
Behaviouralism	A scientific orientation focusing on actual political behaviour, especially of actors such as voters, leaders and groups.
Post-behaviouralism	A corrective within behavioural political science stressing relevance, action and concern for values.
Vernon Van Dyke	Clarifies the distinction between approach and method and explains philosophical analysis as conceptual clarification plus evaluation.
Leo Strauss	Defends political philosophy as inseparable from facts and values and criticizes behavioural value-neutrality.
Graham Wallas and Arthur Bentley	Early forerunners of behaviouralism who shift attention toward actual behaviour and informal processes.
Charles Merriam	Calls for scientific rigour, interdisciplinarity and behavioural inquiry.
Harold Lasswell	Develops politics as the analysis of power and policy.
David Easton	Gives both the behavioural framework and the later post-behavioural call for relevance and action.

- Doctrine reconstruction: method vs approach -> empirical vs normative -> traditional approaches in one line -> behaviouralism's eight tenets (name at least four) -> post-behaviouralism's relevance/action correction.
- Post-behaviouralism kept scientific gains but demanded relevance, action and value-conscious responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- The contemporary shift is marked by behaviouralism, post-behaviouralism and several models of political analysis. (PDF pp.117-134)
- Pure science vs relevance: behaviouralism stressed reliable inquiry; post-behaviouralism added action and public responsibility. (PDF pp.121-122)
- Post-behaviouralism: relevance, action and responsible value concern without discarding scientific gains. (PDF pp.121-122)
- Post-behaviouralism, associated with Easton's own self-correction, retains the scientific gains of behaviouralism (rigour, verification, technique) but adds two demands: relevance - political science must address urgent public problems (war, poverty, discrimination, injustice) rather than only tractable micro-questions - and action -

intellectuals bear responsibility to apply knowledge for social betterment, not merely to accumulate value-neutral findings. (PDF pp.121-122)

- Post-behaviouralism is a corrective within science, not a licence for unexamined activism; relevance still requires disciplined evidence, or it collapses back into the untested moralism political science was trying to escape.
 - Behaviouralism pushed political science toward scientific study of actual political behaviour, regularities, verification and quantification. (PDF pp.118-121)
 - It introduces the major traditional approaches-philosophical, historical, legal and institutional-and the later behavioural turn. (PDF pp.112-122)
 - The traditional approaches are then outlined: philosophical, historical, legal and institutional. (PDF pp.112-117)
 - Method vs approach: methods obtain and use data; approaches decide which questions and data count as relevant. (PDF pp.108-109)
 - Behaviouralism: scientific study of actual behaviour, eight key tenets, micro-level reliability. (PDF pp.118-121)
 - Trap repair: Method and approach are synonyms. -> Approach is wider because it includes selection-criteria for problems and data. (PDF pp.108-109)
 - Trap repair: Traditional always means normative, and contemporary always means empirical. -> Gauba explicitly rejects that mechanical equation. (PDF pp.109-110)
 - Trap repair: Any sentence with "ought" is normative. -> Its content may still be empirical if it states an instrumentally testable condition. (PDF pp.110-111)
 - Trap repair: Value-free means politically consequence-free. -> Behavioural inquiry can shape what gets studied and ignored, which is why post-behaviouralism raised the issue of relevance. (PDF pp.121-122)
 - Trap repair: Post-behaviouralism means abandoning science for activism. -> Easton presents it as retaining behavioural gains while reconnecting them to problem-solving. (PDF pp.121-122)
1. Define the exact doctrine or controversy in the question.
 2. State a qualified thesis before narration begins.
 3. Reconstruct premises, mechanism and conclusion.
 4. Add named thinkers and one precise distinction.
 5. Present the strongest objection, reply and residual limitation.
 6. End with a graded verdict tied to the directive.

GS ownership and final answer route

- **Topic boundary:** traditional, behavioural, post-behavioural and model-based approaches.
- **Exam identity:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only; primarily GS-II conceptual foundations.
- **Evidence rule:** claim -> named thinker/example -> what it proves -> limitation.
- **PYQ rule:** only directly verified Prelims/GS Mains questions may be owned; otherwise use labelled original practice.
- **Advanced rule:** Advanced enrichment is useful for qualification but unnecessary for a competent core GS answer.